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GOVERNANCE DOCUMENT

# Volunteer and Committee Policy

*International Society of Equity Analysts*

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*This document forms part of the official governance framework of the International Society of Equity Analysts (ISEA) and should be read together with the related documents listed above.*

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## 1. Purpose

The International Society of Equity Analysts (“ISEA”) relies on the voluntary contribution of time, expertise and judgement of its Governing Council members, committee members, working group members, taskforce members and other volunteers in the governance, administration and delivery of its professional, educational, membership and standard-setting activities.

This Volunteer and Committee Policy (“Policy”) establishes the framework governing the appointment, responsibilities, conduct, confidentiality obligations, conflicts of interest, expenses, indemnity, reporting obligations, removal and cessation of appointment of ISEA volunteers and committee members.

This Policy is intended to ensure that ISEA’s committees and volunteer structures operate consistently, transparently and in a manner that protects the integrity of ISEA, its Members, its governance processes and the wider equity analysis profession.

This Policy supports ISEA’s Charter and operates alongside other ISEA policies, including the Ethics Policy, the Conflict of Interest Policy, the Code of Ethics and Standards of Professional Conduct, the Whistleblower Policy, the Disciplinary Policy and applicable Committee Charters.

Nothing in this Policy limits or overrides the powers and functions of the Governing Council under the Charter, or the specific terms of any Committee Charter approved by the Governing Council. Where a conflict arises between this Policy and a Committee Charter, the Governing Council shall determine which provision prevails, having regard to the Charter.

## 2. Scope and Application

This Policy applies to:

- **Governing Council members**, including the Chair and Vice-Chair of the Governing Council
- **Committee members**, including chairs, vice-chairs and ordinary members of all standing, ad hoc, advisory and special-purpose committees established by ISEA
- **Working group and taskforce members** convened under the authority of the Governing Council or a committee
- **Volunteers** who assist ISEA in any capacity, including chapter or regional representatives, mentors, examiners, moderators, event volunteers and subject-matter reviewers and
- **Officers and representatives** appointed by ISEA to represent it in an external forum, working party, regulatory consultation or industry body,
- (each, an “Appointee”, and collectively “Appointees”).

This Policy applies from the date an individual accepts an appointment, nomination or invitation referred to above, and continues to apply, where relevant, following cessation of that appointment in accordance with the surviving obligations described in this Policy (including confidentiality and conflicts obligations).

This Policy does not apply to ISEA employees engaged under a contract of employment, whose conduct, appointment and remuneration are governed by their employment terms and applicable ISEA human resources policies, provided that an employee who additionally serves on a committee or as a volunteer in a personal capacity is subject to this Policy in that capacity.

This Policy should be read together with the specific Committee Charter applicable to each committee, which may impose additional or more specific requirements relating to that committee’s composition, quorum, voting and decision-making procedures.

## 3. Definitions and Interpretation

In this Policy, unless the context otherwise requires:

- “**Appointee**” has the meaning given in clause 2
- “**Chair**” means the individual appointed to preside over a committee, working group or taskforce

- **“Committee”** means any standing, ad hoc, advisory or special-purpose body established by the Governing Council or under a Committee Charter, and includes working groups and taskforces unless the context indicates otherwise
- **“Committee Charter”** means the charter or terms of reference approved by the Governing Council for a particular committee
- **“Confidential Information”** has the meaning given in clause 8
- **“Executive Secretariat”** means the Secretary-General and the administrative staff of ISEA who support the Governing Council and its committees
- **“Governing Council”** means the governing body of ISEA established under the Charter
- **“Immediate Family”** means a spouse or domestic partner, parent, child, sibling, and any other relative who resides in the same household as an Appointee
- **“Member”** means a Student Member, Associate Member, Member (MISEA) or Fellow (FISEA) of ISEA
- **“Secretary-General”** means the person holding that office within ISEA’s Executive Secretariat from time to time and
- **“Volunteer”** means an individual described in clause 2 who is not a Governing Council member or committee member but who otherwise assists ISEA in a voluntary, unremunerated or honorarium-based capacity.

Headings are for convenience only and do not affect interpretation. A reference to a policy, framework or Charter includes that document as amended, replaced or superseded from time to time. Words importing the singular include the plural and vice versa.

## 4. Governance Structure of Committees

### 4.1 Types of Committees

ISEA’s committee structure may include, without limitation, standing committees (established on an ongoing basis to support core governance or professional functions), advisory committees (established to provide expert or stakeholder input), regional or chapter committees (established to support Members within a defined geography), and ad hoc committees, working groups or taskforces (established for a defined purpose or period).

The Governing Council determines the committee structure of ISEA from time to time and may, at its discretion, establish, merge, restructure or dissolve any committee.

### 4.2 Establishment and Discontinuation of Committees

A committee is established by resolution of the Governing Council, which shall approve the committee’s Committee Charter, including its purpose, composition, reporting lines and, where applicable, its budget and delegated authority.

A committee may be discontinued by resolution of the Governing Council where its purpose has been fulfilled, is no longer required, or where discontinuation is otherwise in the interests of ISEA.

Discontinuation does not, of itself, extinguish any surviving obligations of former committee members under this Policy.

### 4.3 Committee Charters

Each committee shall operate under a Committee Charter approved by the Governing Council, which shall be consistent with this Policy and shall specify, at a minimum, the committee’s objectives, scope of authority, composition and quorum requirements, meeting frequency, and reporting obligations to the Governing Council.

Where a Committee Charter is silent on a matter addressed by this Policy, this Policy shall apply.

## **5. Appointment of Committee Members and Volunteers**

### **5.1 Eligibility Criteria**

Unless otherwise specified in the relevant Committee Charter, an individual is eligible for appointment as a committee member or volunteer if the individual:

- holds current Membership of ISEA at the relevant Membership grade specified for the role, where Membership is a stated requirement of that role
- is not currently suspended or expelled from ISEA Membership, and has no unresolved disciplinary matter that the Governing Council considers relevant to the appointment
- has disclosed any actual, potential or perceived conflicts of interest relevant to the role in accordance with clause 7 and
- has the relevant skills, experience, availability and, where applicable, independence appropriate to the role.

The Governing Council or the relevant committee, as applicable, may adopt additional eligibility criteria for particular roles, including requirements relating to geographic or sectoral representation, diversity of perspective, or professional designation.

### **5.2 Nomination and Selection Process**

Appointments to committees and volunteer roles shall be made through a nomination and selection process determined by the Governing Council or the relevant committee, which may include open calls for expressions of interest, nomination by existing committee members, or invitation by the Secretary-General.

Selection decisions shall have regard to the eligibility criteria in clause 5.1, the needs of the committee, and, where applicable, the desirability of maintaining an appropriate diversity of professional background, geography, gender and seniority across ISEA's committee structure.

An appointment takes effect only upon written confirmation by the Secretary-General or the relevant committee Chair, and upon the appointee's written acknowledgement of, and agreement to comply with, this Policy and any other applicable ISEA requirements.

### **5.3 Terms of Appointment**

Unless otherwise specified in the relevant Committee Charter, appointments to a committee are for a term of one (1) year, renewable for no more than two further consecutive terms, after which a period of at least one (1) year must elapse before the individual is eligible for re-appointment to the same committee, unless the Governing Council determines that an exception is warranted having regard to continuity, expertise or succession considerations.

The Governing Council may stagger the terms of committee members to preserve continuity of institutional knowledge within a committee.

### **5.4 Induction and Onboarding**

The Executive Secretariat shall provide each newly appointed committee member and volunteer with an induction covering, at a minimum, the applicable Committee Charter, this Policy, the Ethics Policy, the Conflict of Interest Policy, the Confidentiality obligations in clause 8, and any specific procedural or reporting requirements relevant to the role.

### **5.5 Re-appointment**

Re-appointment at the end of a term is not automatic. The Governing Council or relevant committee shall have regard to the individual's attendance, contribution, conduct and continued eligibility when considering re-appointment.

## **6. Roles and Responsibilities**

### **6.1 General Responsibilities of Committee Members and Volunteers**

Committee members and volunteers shall:

- act honestly, in good faith and in the best interests of ISEA and its Members as a whole, rather than in the interests of any particular constituency, employer, sponsor or personal interest
- exercise reasonable care, skill and diligence in performing their role
- attend and participate constructively in meetings and, where unable to attend, provide reasonable advance notice to the Chair or Secretariat
- familiarise themselves with, and comply with, the applicable Committee Charter, this Policy and other applicable ISEA policies and
- act within the scope of authority delegated to the relevant committee and refrain from making representations on behalf of ISEA beyond that scope without proper authorisation.

### **6.2 Responsibilities of Committee Chairs**

In addition to the responsibilities in clause 6.1, a committee Chair is responsible for providing leadership to the committee, setting agendas in consultation with the Secretariat, ensuring balanced participation among committee members, escalating matters requiring Governing Council attention, and ensuring the committee reports to the Governing Council in accordance with clause 13.

A committee Chair should ensure that meetings are conducted efficiently, that dissenting views are appropriately recorded, and that decisions are made in accordance with the quorum and voting requirements set out in the relevant Committee Charter.

### **6.3 Responsibilities of the Secretary-General and Executive Secretariat**

The Secretary-General and Executive Secretariat provide administrative and governance support to committees, including scheduling meetings, distributing papers, maintaining minutes and records in accordance with the Document Retention Policy, and supporting the induction, appointment and, where relevant, removal processes described in this Policy.

### **6.4 Time Commitment and Attendance**

Committee members and volunteers are expected to commit sufficient time to fulfil their role effectively, including preparation for and attendance at meetings. A committee member who is absent, without reasonable excuse, from more than half of a committee's scheduled meetings within a twelve-month period may be treated as having resigned in accordance with clause 10.3, subject to the Chair first raising the matter with the individual concerned.

## **7. Conflicts of Interest**

### **7.1 Identification of Conflicts**

Committee members and volunteers must proactively identify circumstances in which their personal, professional, financial or other interests, or those of their employer, clients or Immediate Family, could conflict, or could reasonably be perceived to conflict, with their duties to ISEA.

A conflict of interest may arise, for example, where a matter before a committee could affect the commercial interests of the Appointee's employer, where the Appointee has a financial interest in the outcome of a decision, or where the Appointee's objectivity could reasonably be questioned because of a personal or professional relationship with a person affected by the matter.

### **7.2 Disclosure Obligations**

Committee members and volunteers must disclose actual, potential or perceived conflicts of interest to the Chair of the relevant committee (or, in the case of the Chair's own conflict, to the Secretary-General) as soon as practicable, and in any event before participating in the discussion or decision to which the conflict relates.

Disclosures must be recorded in the minutes of the relevant meeting and in the register of interests described in clause 7.4.

### **7.3 Management of Conflicts**

On disclosure of a conflict, the Chair (or, where the conflict concerns the Chair, the Vice-Chair or another committee member nominated by the Secretary-General) shall determine the appropriate management response, which may include requiring the Appointee to:

- refrain from participating in the discussion of the relevant matter
- withdraw from the meeting, or the relevant part of the meeting, during consideration of the matter
- abstain from voting on the matter or
- in serious or recurring cases, step down from the committee in relation to matters of that kind, or from the committee altogether.

This clause 7 operates in addition to, and does not limit, the requirements of ISEA's Conflict of Interest Policy, which shall prevail to the extent of any inconsistency.

### **7.4 Register of Interests**

The Executive Secretariat shall maintain a register of interests recording disclosures made under this clause 7. Committee members and volunteers must update their disclosures promptly upon any material change in circumstances, and in any event review and confirm their disclosures on an annual basis.

## **8. Confidentiality and Information Handling**

### **8.1 General Confidentiality Obligations**

In the course of their appointment, committee members and volunteers may have access to information that is not publicly available, including draft policies, deliberations of the Governing Council or a committee, Member complaints or disciplinary matters, examination materials, financial information, and information provided in confidence by Members, applicants or third parties ("Confidential Information").

Committee members and volunteers must not disclose Confidential Information to any third party, or use Confidential Information for any purpose other than the proper performance of their role, except:

- with the prior written authorisation of the Secretary-General or the Governing Council
- where disclosure is required by law, regulation or a valid order of a court or regulator, in which case the individual should, where legally permitted, notify the Secretary-General before making the disclosure or
- where the information has already lawfully entered the public domain other than through a breach of this clause.

### **8.2 Use and Protection of Confidential Information**

Committee members and volunteers must take reasonable steps to protect Confidential Information from unauthorised access, including by using ISEA-approved systems for storing and transmitting committee materials where these are made available, and by not retaining Confidential Information beyond the period reasonably necessary for the performance of their role.

Committee deliberations, including differing views expressed during discussion, are confidential to the committee unless and until a decision or communication is formally approved for release.

### **8.3 Continuing Obligations After Cessation**

The obligations in this clause 8 survive the cessation of an individual's appointment for any reason, and continue to apply for so long as the relevant information remains confidential.

## **9. Standards of Conduct**

### **9.1 General Standards**

Committee members and volunteers must at all times comply with the Ethics Policy and the Code of Ethics and Standards of Professional Conduct, and must otherwise conduct themselves in a manner consistent with ISEA's reputation for integrity and professionalism, including in their interactions with

Members, ISEA staff, other Appointees and external stakeholders.

Committee members and volunteers must not engage in conduct that is discriminatory, harassing, bullying or otherwise inconsistent with a respectful and inclusive working environment.

### **9.2 Use of ISEA Resources, Name and Brand**

Committee members and volunteers must use ISEA resources, including its name, logo, letterhead and confidential systems, only for purposes properly connected with their role, and must not use ISEA's name or brand to endorse, or appear to endorse, any commercial product, service or organisation without the prior written approval of the Secretary-General.

### **9.3 External Communications and Social Media**

Committee members and volunteers must not make public statements, including on social media, on behalf of ISEA unless authorised to do so, and should make clear, where they comment publicly on matters relevant to ISEA in a personal capacity, that the views expressed are their own and not those of ISEA.

### **9.4 Gifts, Benefits and Hospitality**

Committee members and volunteers must not solicit, and should decline or refer to the Secretary-General, any gift, benefit or hospitality offered in connection with their role that could reasonably be perceived to influence, or to be intended to influence, the performance of their duties, other than benefits of modest, customary or nominal value.

## **10. Resignation, Removal and Cessation of Appointment**

### **10.1 Resignation**

A committee member or volunteer may resign at any time by giving written notice to the Chair of the relevant committee or to the Secretary-General. Except in urgent circumstances, at least thirty days' notice should be given to allow for an orderly handover.

### **10.2 Removal for Cause**

The Governing Council may remove a committee member or volunteer from their appointment at any time, with or without notice, where the individual:

- has breached this Policy, the applicable Committee Charter, the Ethics Policy or the Code
- has failed, without reasonable excuse, to meet the standards of attendance, participation or conduct expected of the role
- has an unmanageable or undisclosed conflict of interest
- has ceased to meet the eligibility criteria for the role, including through suspension or expulsion from ISEA Membership or
- is, in the reasonable opinion of the Governing Council, no longer able to perform the role effectively or in a manner consistent with ISEA's interests.

Save in urgent cases or cases involving a serious breach, an individual subject to potential removal should be given a reasonable opportunity to respond before a final decision is made. A decision to remove a committee member or volunteer, and the reasons for it, shall be recorded by the Executive Secretariat.

### **10.3 Automatic Cessation**

An individual's appointment ceases automatically, without the need for further action by the Governing Council, upon the expiry of their term (unless renewed in accordance with clause 5.3), upon the

individual's death, or upon the individual otherwise ceasing to satisfy a mandatory eligibility requirement of the role specified in the applicable Committee Charter.

#### **10.4 Effect of Cessation**

On cessation of an appointment for any reason, the individual must promptly return or destroy all ISEA materials and Confidential Information in their possession, cease to represent themselves as holding the relevant role, and remains bound by the confidentiality and conflicts obligations described in clauses 7 and 8 to the extent they survive cessation.

### **11. Expenses and Reimbursement**

#### **11.1 General Principles**

Committee members and volunteers serve in a voluntary capacity and are not remunerated for their time unless the Governing Council determines otherwise for a specific role. ISEA will, however, reimburse reasonable, properly incurred and pre-approved expenses in accordance with this clause 11 and any expense guidelines issued by the Executive Secretariat from time to time.

#### **11.2 Eligible Expenses**

Subject to prior approval and any applicable expense guidelines, eligible expenses may include reasonable travel, accommodation and subsistence costs incurred in attending in-person committee meetings or representing ISEA at an authorised event, and other direct out-of-pocket costs reasonably and necessarily incurred in the performance of the role.

Expenses should be incurred economically, having regard to ISEA's status as a not-for-profit professional association, and business or premium-class travel will only be reimbursed in limited circumstances approved in advance by the Secretary-General.

#### **11.3 Claims Process**

Claims for reimbursement must be submitted to the Executive Secretariat in the form and within the timeframe specified in ISEA's expense guidelines, supported by original receipts or other satisfactory evidence of expenditure. Claims submitted more than ninety days after the expense was incurred may be declined at ISEA's discretion.

#### **11.4 Non-Reimbursable Expenses**

ISEA will not reimburse expenses that are not properly connected with an individual's role, expenses incurred without required pre-approval, fines or penalties, or expenses that would give rise to a conflict of interest or the appearance of impropriety.

### **12. Indemnity and Limitation of Liability**

#### **12.1 Indemnity**

Subject to applicable law and ISEA's Charter, ISEA shall indemnify each Governing Council member and committee member, out of the assets of ISEA, against liability reasonably incurred by that individual in connection with the proper performance of their role, including reasonable legal costs, provided that the individual acted honestly, in good faith and within the scope of their authority, and did not act fraudulently, with wilful misconduct, or in a manner constituting a serious or knowing breach of this Policy.

This indemnity does not extend to liability arising from an individual's fraud, dishonesty, wilful default, gross negligence, or knowing breach of applicable law or ISEA policy.

#### **12.2 Limitation of Liability**

To the maximum extent permitted by applicable law, no committee member or volunteer shall be personally liable for any act or omission done in good faith in the proper performance of their role, and any liability that would otherwise attach to the individual shall, to that extent, attach instead to ISEA.

### **12.3 Insurance**

ISEA shall maintain directors' and officers' liability insurance, or equivalent cover, for the benefit of Governing Council members and committee members, in such amount and on such terms as the Governing Council considers appropriate from time to time, and shall provide committee members with reasonable information as to the scope of that cover on request.

## **13. Committee Reporting and Accountability**

### **13.1 Reporting to the Governing Council**

Each committee shall report to the Governing Council in accordance with the frequency and format specified in its Committee Charter, and in any event at least once per year, covering the committee's activities, key decisions, matters escalated for the Governing Council's attention, and any material risks or conflicts identified.

A committee Chair, or the Secretary-General on the Chair's behalf, shall promptly escalate to the Governing Council any matter that could materially affect ISEA's reputation, financial position or legal or regulatory standing.

### **13.2 Minutes and Records**

Minutes of committee meetings shall be prepared by, or under the supervision of, the Executive Secretariat, circulated to committee members for review within a reasonable period, and retained in accordance with the Document Retention Policy. Minutes shall record attendance, key discussion points, decisions taken, dissenting views (where a member requests this), and any conflict of interest disclosures made under clause 7.

### **13.3 Performance Review**

The Governing Council may, from time to time, review the performance and continued relevance of a committee, including through self-assessment by committee members, feedback from Members, or an independent review, and may make recommendations arising from that review, including as to the committee's composition, mandate or continuation.

## **14. Review and Continuous Improvement**

This Policy shall be reviewed by the Governing Council periodically, and in any event at least once every three years, to ensure that it remains fit for purpose, consistent with applicable law and regulation, and aligned with good governance practice among comparable international professional associations.

The Governing Council may also review this Policy earlier than scheduled where prompted by a material change in ISEA's governance structure, a lesson identified through the operation of a committee, feedback from committee members, Members or other stakeholders, or a relevant legal or regulatory development.

The Secretary-General is responsible for monitoring the effectiveness of this Policy in practice and for bringing recommendations for improvement to the Governing Council.

## **15. Effective Date**

This Policy takes effect from the date of its approval by the Governing Council and remains in effect until amended, replaced or withdrawn by a further resolution of the Governing Council.